

Prayagraj Heritage Guide

PRA001: Triveni Sangam. The Triveni Sangam is one of the most sacred sites in Hinduism, located in Prayagraj. It marks the spectacular confluence of three rivers: the muddy, pale-yellow waters of the Ganges, the clear green waters of the Yamuna, and the invisible, mythical Saraswati River. According to Hindu mythology, bathing in these sacred waters washes away all sins and frees one from the cycle of rebirth. The Sangam is the site of the massive Kumbh Mela, held every 12 years, which is the largest peaceful gathering of humans on Earth, drawing over 100 million pilgrims.

PRA002: Allahabad Fort. Built by the great Mughal Emperor Akbar in 1583, the Allahabad Fort stands majestically on the banks of the Yamuna River near its confluence with the Ganges. Recognizing the strategic and religious importance of Prayagraj, Akbar constructed this massive fort, making it the largest fort built by him. The complex is known for its design, craftsmanship, and massive walls. It houses the famous Ashoka Pillar, dating back to 232 BCE, and the underground Patalpuri Temple. Today, the fort is largely occupied by the Indian Army, with only limited areas open to the general public.

PRA003: Khusro Bagh. Khusro Bagh is a large, walled historical garden and burial complex dating back to the Mughal era. It houses the magnificent sandstone tombs of Prince Khusro (the eldest son of Emperor Jahangir who rebelled against his father), his Rajput mother Shah Begum, and his sister Nithar Begum. The tombs are exquisite examples of Mughal architecture, adorned with detailed stone carvings, elegant pavilions, and beautiful Persian motifs. The tranquil garden is heavily planted with mango and guava trees, offering a peaceful retreat from the bustling city while reflecting the tragic royal history of the Mughal dynasty.

PRA004: Anand Bhavan. Anand Bhavan is a historic house museum that served as the ancestral home of the Nehru-Gandhi family, one of India's most prominent political dynasties. Originally purchased by Motilal Nehru in the 1930s, the sprawling mansion became the epicenter of the Indian

Independence Movement, hosting crucial meetings with leaders like Mahatma Gandhi. It was the childhood home of India's first Prime Minister, Jawaharlal Nehru, and Indira Gandhi. In 1970, Indira Gandhi donated the house to the Indian government to be converted into a museum, which now preserves the family's furniture, extensive library, and rare historical photographs.

PRA005: Chandrashekhar Azad Park. Formerly known as Alfred Park or Company Bagh, this is the largest public park in Prayagraj, spanning 133 acres. Built in 1870 to mark Prince Alfred's visit to the city, the park is steeped in Indian revolutionary history. It is most famous as the site where the legendary freedom fighter Chandrashekhar Azad engaged in a fierce gun battle with the British police in 1931. Surrounded and out of ammunition, Azad famously shot himself to remain uncaptured, fulfilling his vow to never be taken alive. Today, a striking memorial statue of Azad stands at the exact location.